so and was told that if that were the case then he should do what he had been advised. When the trio made up of two SPs and DSP realized that the ASP had also met the CM, it took the wind out of their sails.

What is even more interesting is that the chief minister did not choose to refer back to his DIG for information or confirmation but rather chose to become angry with Kiran. And so, her daughter Saina was not to be allowed her due.

(In passing one may mention that after Kiran's transfer from Mizoram not much later, the non-Mizo DSP mentioned earlier was suspended from service.)

Kiran decided to meet Health Minister Vaivenga and ask him directly about the progress of her daughter's case. He suggested that she try to somehow wangle a seat from Delhi because it was going to be very difficult to do so from Mizoram. 'Why should I?' she demanded, and asked him to give her daughter's standing in the merit list that was on the minister's table. He looked at it and merely suggested that she speak to the chief minister.

Instead of the CM, Kiran decided to look up the chief secretary, Pahnuna. She thought that because he was the chief of administration he would at least possess some concern for merit and fair play. She explained to him that although her daughter belonged to Delhi she could not appear for the examinations there because she had not done her higher secondary schooling from there and that although she had done her higher secondary from Mizoram, she could not appear from here because she was not a Mizo. She then posed the question as to where did the chief secretary think her daughter should appear from? He gave this matter a little thought and suggested that she meet the chief minister.

Not deterred by this reply Kiran decided to meet the CM and personally explain her daughter's case. She decided to first have some other Mizo officer outline the case to him and then seek permission for an interview. The interview was granted soon enough. She put her case forcefully enough. She first showed him the application form as it had come back after being rejected from Delhi (to appear from there). She then recalled for him the recent Guwahati High Court judgement regarding seat allotments on the basis of merit. And then, in the form of a coup de grâce, she reminded him of the colossal and callous bungling of her father's operation because of ill-equipped and substandard hospitals in Mizoram. The family bore it out with fortitude and never once complained. Had they done so, Kiran was quick to inform him, she and her three sisters would not have to work all their lives in order to earn money.

The position of the chief minister was clear. If he himself did not clear the list, then Kiran had enough justifiable documents to have the courts direct him to do so. Then and there he issued orders for the allotment of a seat to Saina in the Lady Hardinge Medical College in Delhi.

She flew to Delhi the same day to get her daughter admitted (before the Mizos changed their mind again).

* * *

While she was still in Delhi after having got Saina admitted to the Lady Hardinge Medical College, Kiran was informed that people had held massive demonstrations in Aizawl and that they had launched an agitation there against her. Despite her parents' attempts to stall her departure, she went back to rejoin duties. Aizawl greeted her with black banners, placards and shouts of '*Kiran Bedi Go Back*'.

Her decision not to lead the police personally from the front against the agitators was quite justifiable, keeping in mind the fact that her best of intentions could be construed as biased. This decision was also in keeping with the views of the chief secretary, although there were many who